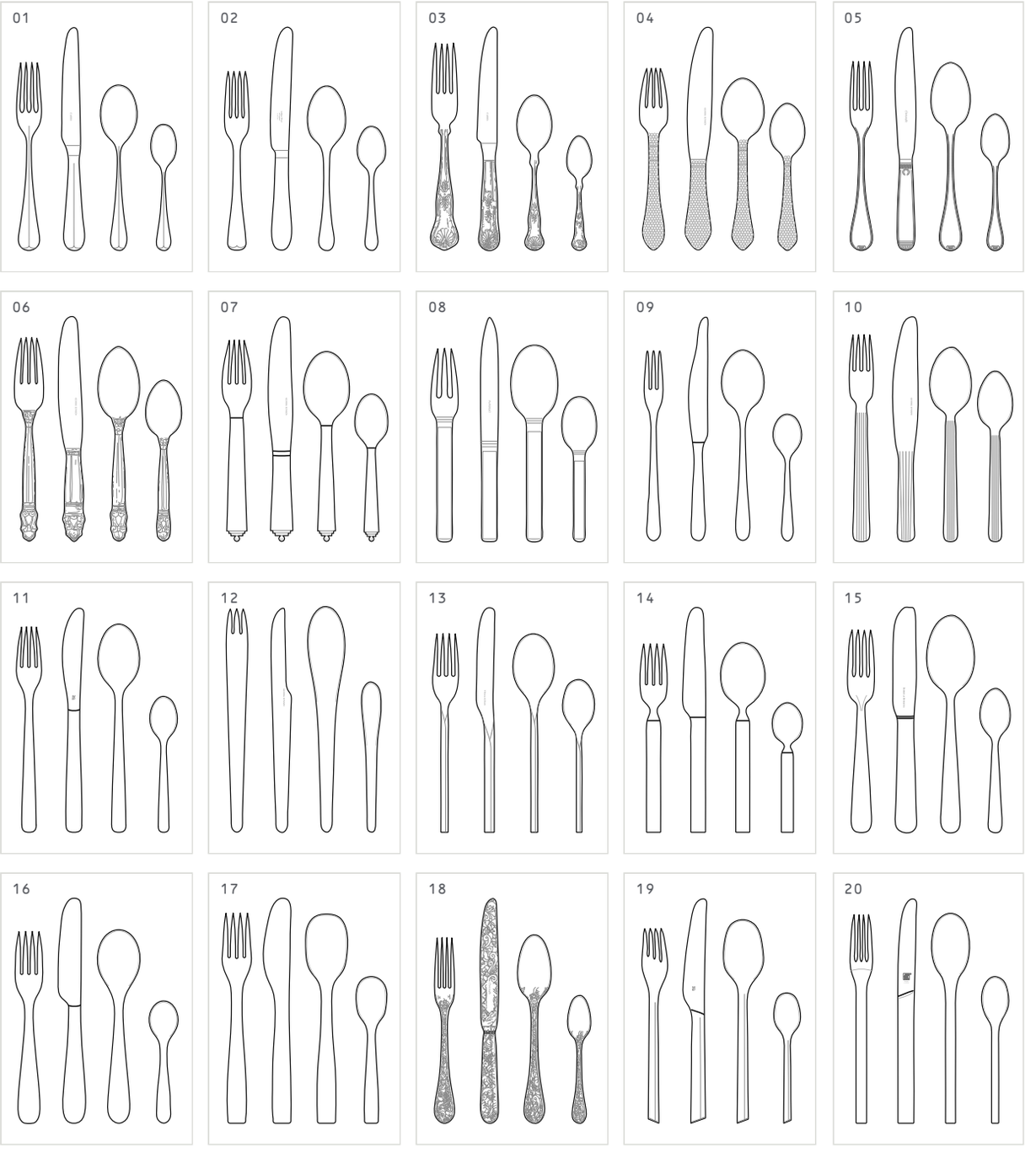
PORTFOLIO · 2026

Forkfont

Fonts × Cutlery

Twenty open-source typefaces paired with twenty cutlery sets, matched by character.



Yuli Wu
wuyu.li · mail@wuyu.li

Forkfont

Typefaces and cutlery are used every day, yet rarely given the attention they deserve. Forkfont pairs twenty open-source typefaces with twenty cutlery sets still made today, matched by character: the same era, the same gesture or the same temperament. Fine words deserve exquisite type, just as delicacies deserve radiant silverware. The ink is ready, and the table is laid. Bon appétit!

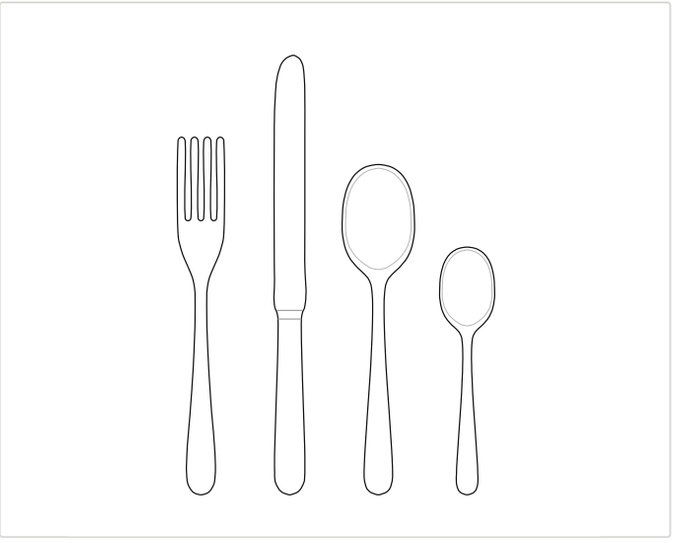
A portfolio by Yuli Wu

CV https://wuyu.li

CONTACT mail@wuyu.li

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger



Fork · Knife · Teaspoon · Coffee spoon

How to read a pairing

Contrast
even → high

Thick against thin in the stroke; change of width along the piece.

Ornament
none → rich

Swashes and detail; beads, shells, fluting, engraving.

Geometry
organic → constructed

Pen and modelled curves; compass, ruler, steps and facets.

Weight
light → robust

Stroke heaviness; visual mass, slender to substantial.

Formality
casual → ceremonial

Everyday table and screen; state banquet and invitation.

Finish
handmade → machined

Written, hammered, chased; engineered, pressed, polished.

Aa Font Cutlery SCORES 1 TO 5, EDITORIAL

Fonts from Google Fonts under open licences. Cutlery names belong to their makers; every "See it" link goes to the maker's current product page. Profile scores are editorial readings of the cited sources. Interface type: TeX Gyre Heros, a free Helvetica-style font, and OCR-B by Adrian Frutiger.

Aa FONT

Libre Caslon Text

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

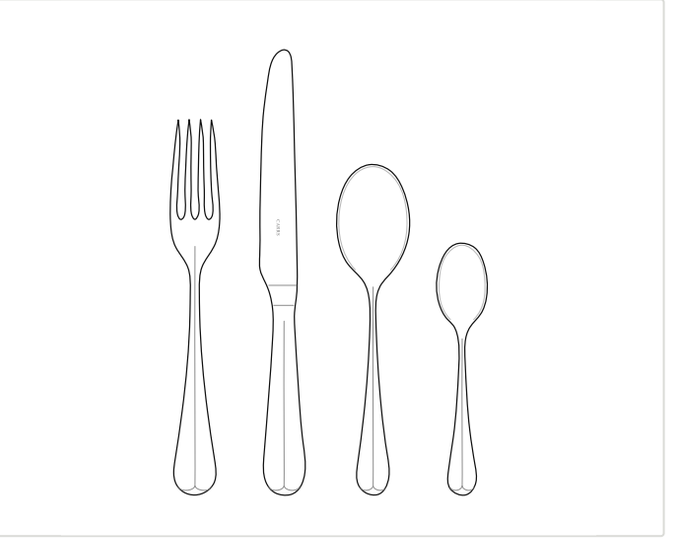
“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Pablo Impallari
MODEL	William Caslon's romans, London, 1720s-30s, via mid-century hand-lettered Caslon
CLASS	Serif · old-style · on Google Fonts since 2020

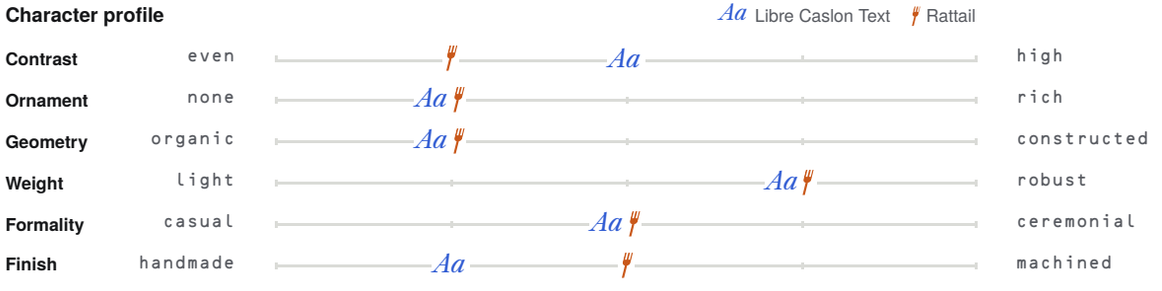
CUTLERY · ARTHUR PRICE

Rattail



DESIGNER	Traditional English pattern, made by Arthur Price
MATERIAL	Silver-plated or stainless steel
FORM	Rat-tail ridge behind the bowl, central ridge on the stem, rounded end turned up; finger-point knife blade

Character profile



Why they match

Caslon was the everyday type of Georgian England, and the rat-tail spoon was the everyday spoon of the same decades; Arthur Price still makes it today. Both are sturdy rather than showy: moderate contrast, generous proportions, and ornament kept to a bracketed serif or a single ridge.

Sources: arthurprice.com · antiquesilverspoons.co.uk · Google Fonts

See it at Arthur Price ↗

Aa FONT

Libre Baskerville

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

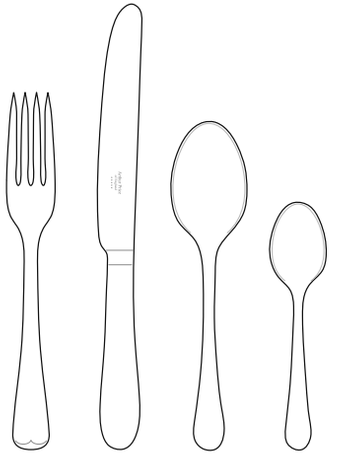
“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Impallari Type (Pablo Impallari)
MODEL	John Baskerville, Birmingham, 1750s, via American Type Founders' Baskerville of 1941
CLASS	Serif · transitional · on Google Fonts since 2012

CUTLERY · ARTHUR PRICE

Old English



DESIGNER	Traditional English pattern, made by Arthur Price
MATERIAL	Silver-plated or stainless steel
FORM	Plain rounded end; the pip sits on the back of the spoon because Georgian spoons were laid face down; three knife blades to choose from

Character profile

Aa Libre Baskerville · Old English

Contrast	even	Old English · Libre Baskerville	high
Ornament	none	Libre Baskerville · Old English	rich
Geometry	organic	Libre Baskerville · Old English	constructed
Weight	light	Libre Baskerville · Old English	robust
Formality	casual	Libre Baskerville · Old English	ceremonial
Finish	handmade	Libre Baskerville	machined

Why they match

Both mark the late Georgian turn from sturdy to refined. Baskerville sharpened the contrast and opened up the letterforms; Old English grew out of the Rattail by dropping the ridge and calming the end into one plain curve. In each, elegance comes from proportion rather than ornament.

Sources: arthurprice.com · carrs-silver.co.uk · antiquesilverspoons.co.uk · Google Fonts

See it at Arthur Price ↗

Aa FONT

Pinyon Script

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

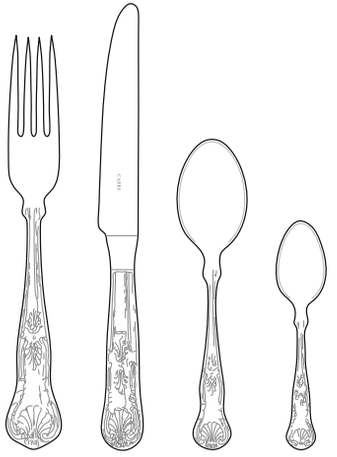
0123456789

"If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape."

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Nicole Fally
MODEL	A romantic round hand with high stroke contrast, a steep slant and confident, showy swashes
CLASS	Script · round hand · on Google Fonts since 2011

Kings



DESIGNER	Traditional pattern; Carrs credits its version to John and Henry Lias of London, 1830s
MATERIAL	Hallmarked sterling silver or silver-plate
FORM	Hourglass-shaped handle; opulent Rococo decoration of shells and foliate scrolls; heavy in the hand

Character profile



Why they match

Both are dressed for an occasion. Kings piles shells and foliate scrolls onto an hourglass handle; Pinyon Script adds confident, showy swashes to a high-contrast round hand. The one axis where they part is weight: the script is light on the page, while the silver is heavy in the hand.

Sources: carrs-silver.co.uk · arthurprice.com · antiquesilverspoons.co.uk · Google Fonts

See it at Carrs of Sheffield ↗

Aa FONT

IM Fell English

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

> “If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”
>
> - Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Igino Marini
MODEL	The Fell Types gathered by Bishop John Fell for Oxford from 1668, the oldest surviving punches in England
CLASS	Serif · old-style · on Google Fonts since 2010

CUTLERY · GEORG JENSEN

Continental (Antik)



DESIGNER	Georg Jensen
MATERIAL	Sterling silver
FORM	Lightly hammered (planished) surface that gives the silver depth; shapes drawn from centuries-old Nordic tools

Character profile



Why they match

Both keep the marks of making. Jensen left the hammer's planishing on the silver; the Fell Types keep a rough, hand-cut character that even Stanley Morison found “impossible wholly to approve”. Neither is polished into perfection, and both borrow their authority from much older tools.

Sources: georgjensen.com · leopardantiques.com · Google Fonts

See it at Georg Jensen ↗

Playfair Display

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

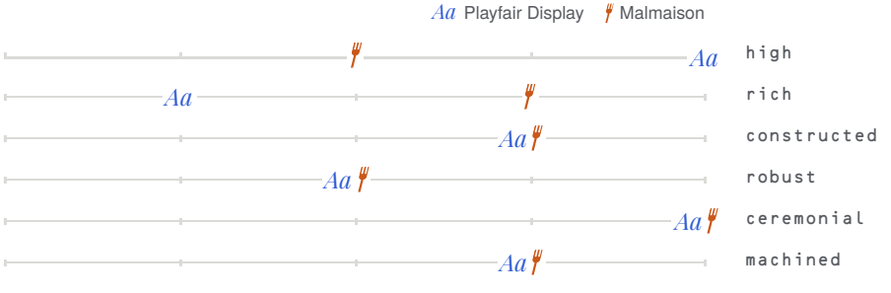
DESIGNER	Claus Eggers Sørensen
MODEL	Late 18th-century romans of the pointed steel pen, after John Baskerville and the Scotch Romans
CLASS	Serif · transitional, high contrast · on Google Fonts since 2011

Malmaison



DESIGNER	Christofle in-house; no designer named
MATERIAL	Silver-plated or sterling silver
FORM	Alternating water leaves and palmettes in delicate relief; strict symmetry

Character profile



Why they match

High-contrast type and the Empire style come from the same neoclassical moment around 1800: vertical stress, crisp edges, strict symmetry. Playfair sets hairlines against heavy stems; Malmaison sets palmettes in delicate relief against polished silver. Both read as formal from across the room.

Sources: christofle.com · Google Fonts

See it at Christofle ↗

Aa FONT

EB Garamond

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Georg Duffner, Octavio Pardo
MODEL	Claude Garamont's mid-16th-century romans, read from the 1592 Egenolff-Berner specimen
CLASS	Serif · Garalde · on Google Fonts since 2011

Acorn (Konge)



DESIGNER	Johan Rohde
MATERIAL	Sterling silver
FORM	Ridged stem; a stylised acorn above two scrolls at the handle end; crisp ornament that emphasises the form

Character profile

Aa EB Garamond · Acorn

Contrast	even	*Aa*	high
Ornament	none	*Aa*	rich
Geometry	organic	*Aa*	constructed
Weight	light	*Aa*	robust
Formality	casual	*Aa*	ceremonial
Finish	handmade	*Aa*	machined

Why they match

Each is its field's beautiful default: the pattern a family inherits, the face a book is set in when it should simply look right. Ornament is present but subordinate, a small acorn or a bracketed serif, always in service of the form rather than in front of it.

Sources: georgjensen.com · antiquesilverspoons.co.uk · kunsthaus-kende.de · Google Fonts

See it at Georg Jensen ↗

Aa FONT

Limelight

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

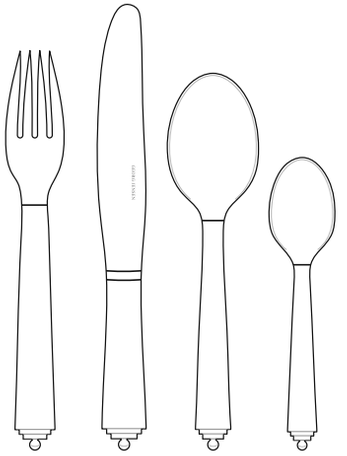
“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Nicole Fally, Sorkin Type
MODEL	The classic high-contrast Art Deco geometric sans, a style that evokes the 1920s, theatre and Hollywood
CLASS	Display · Art Deco · on Google Fonts since 2011

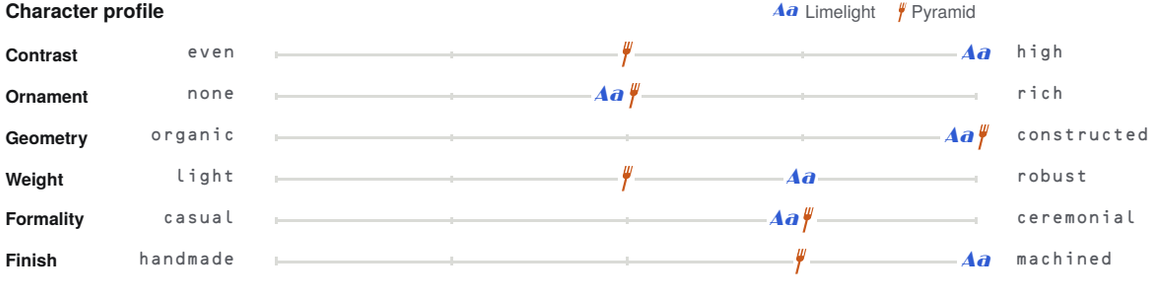
CUTLERY · GEORG JENSEN

Pyramid



DESIGNER	Harald Nielsen
MATERIAL	Sterling silver or mirror-polished stainless steel
FORM	Stepped, ziggurat-like finial topped by a small ball; straight, classic lines

Character profile



Why they match

Both are 1920s geometry with a sense of theatre. Limelight builds letters from circles and verticals with abrupt shifts from thick to thin; Pyramid steps its finial like a ziggurat. The ornament is architectural, never floral, and it frames the form instead of covering it.

Sources: georgjensen.com · fjorn.com · Google Fonts

See it at Georg Jensen ↗

Aa FONT

Poiret One

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

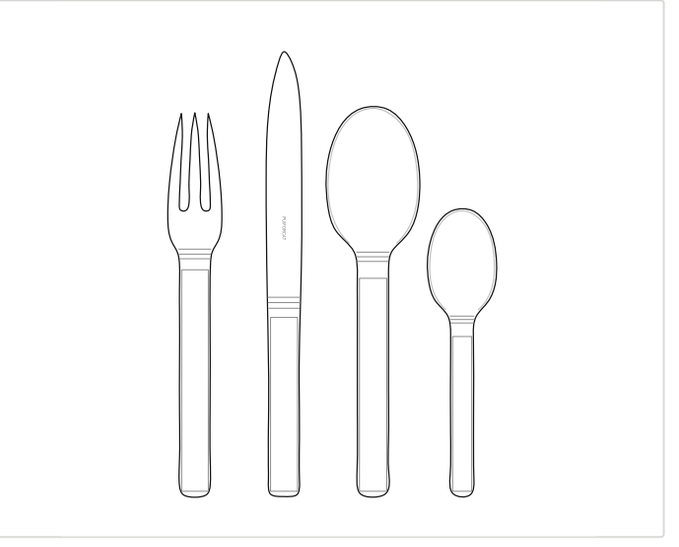
0123456789

"If you remember the shape of a spoon
with which you just ate some soup,
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– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Denis Masharov
MODEL	A decorative geometric grotesque with a hint of Art Deco and constructivism, light and sleek
CLASS	Display · geometric · on Google Fonts since 2012

Cannes



DESIGNER	Jean Puiforcat
MATERIAL	Sterling silver (950)
FORM	Cylindrical handle centre; five raised rings at the crown; fluting; mirror finish

Character profile

Aa Poiret One · Cannes

Contrast	even	Aa	high
Ornament	none	Aa	rich
Geometry	organic	Aa	constructed
Weight	light	Aa	robust
Formality	casual	Aa	ceremonial
Finish	handmade	Aa	machined

Why they match

Both are drawn with compass and ruler. Cannes stacks raised rings on a cylinder; Poiret One builds letters from circles and fine straight strokes. In each the decoration is made of geometry rather than added to it, which gives both the same cool, precise glamour.

Sources: puiforcat.com · kneenandco.com · Google Fonts

See it at Puiforcat ↗

Aa FONT

Bodoni Moda

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Owen Earl (indestructible type*)
MODEL	Giambattista Bodoni, Parma, late 18th century; a full digital family with optical sizes
CLASS	Serif · Didone · on Google Fonts since 2020

CUTLERY · ALESSI

09 / 20

Caccia



DESIGNER	Luigi Caccia Dominioni with Livio and Pier Giacomo Castiglioni
MATERIAL	18/10 stainless steel, made by Alessi since 1990 (originally silver)
FORM	Slender and very elongated; no ornament; polished; table fork with three or four prongs

Character profile

Aa Bodoni Moda · Caccia

Contrast	even	high
Ornament	none	rich
Geometry	organic	constructed
Weight	light	robust
Formality	casual	ceremonial
Finish	handmade	machined

Why they match

Two Northern Italian classics reduced to proportion. Bodoni, in Parma, stripped the letter to thick stem, hairline and ball; Caccia stripped the fork to one long, slender line. Neither needs ornament: all of the drama is in the thinness.

Sources: alessi.com · connox.com · Google Fonts

See it at Alessi ↗

Aa FONT

Josefin Sans

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Santiago Orozco
MODEL	Geometric sans-serifs of the 1920s; an unusual x-height halfway to the cap height
CLASS	Sans · geometric · on Google Fonts since 2010

Bernadotte



DESIGNER	Sigvard Bernadotte
MATERIAL	Sterling silver or mirror-polished stainless steel
FORM	Ribbed, fluted handles set against smooth, continuous forms; the ribs also give a secure grip

Character profile



Why they match

Both belong to the moment when Art Deco calmed into functionalism. Josefin's even strokes and unusually low lowercase give it a disciplined, vintage rhythm; Bernadotte gets its rhythm from parallel fluting on an otherwise smooth handle. Elegance by repetition, not decoration.

Sources: georgjensen.com · NGV collection · sothebys.com · Google Fonts

See it at Georg Jensen ↗

Work Sans

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Wei Huang
MODEL	Loosely based on early grotesques by Stephenson Blake, Miller & Richard and the Bauersche Giesserei
CLASS	Sans · grotesque · on Google Fonts since 2015

Kult (Kult Plus sets)



DESIGNER	Credited by WMF to Strauss; full name not published
MATERIAL	Cromargan protect 18/10 stainless steel, polished
FORM	Clean contours and modern proportions; no ornament; table knife with an inserted forged blade

Character profile



Why they match

Both are tools first. WMF sums up Kult as “finding beauty in simple functionality”: clean contours, modern proportions and nothing added. Work Sans revives the plain grotesques that foundries made for everyday print. Neither asks to be noticed; both simply work.

Sources: wmf.com · Google Fonts

See it at WMF ↗

Jost

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Owen Earl (indestructible type*)
MODEL	1920s German geometric sans-serifs, the family Futura belongs to
CLASS	Sans · geometric · on Google Fonts since 2020

Arne Jacobsen (AJ)



DESIGNER	Arne Jacobsen; made by A. Michelsen until about 1977, then Georg Jensen
MATERIAL	Matte stainless steel
FORM	Flat sheet steel; only the contour marks handle from blade; short tines; asymmetric spoons

Character profile



Why they match

Kubrick put both futures on screen. Jacobsen's cutlery sits on the table in 2001: A Space Odyssey, and Futura sets two of its act titles and much of its signage. AJ reduces a knife to one flat contour; Futura reduces letters to circle, triangle and line. Jost carries that geometry today.

Sources: georgjensen.com · moma.org · typesetinthefuture.com · Google Fonts

See it at Georg Jensen ↗

Comfortaa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Johan Aakerlund
MODEL	A rounded geometric sans built from circles and even strokes, intended for large sizes
CLASS	Display · rounded geometric · on Google Fonts since 2011

NewWave



DESIGNER	Not named by Villeroy & Boch
MATERIAL	18/10 stainless steel, polished
FORM	Sleek lines and ergonomic shapes; a continuous wave-like profile from handle to tip; the knife balances on the edge of its handle

Character profile



Why they match

Both read as one smooth, unbroken stroke. NewWave runs a continuous, wave-like silhouette from handle to tip; Comfortaa builds its letters from rounded strokes of even weight. Comfortaa is more geometric than the wave, but the two share the same easy, playful temperament.

Sources: villeroy-boch.com · perigold.com · Google Fonts

See it at Villeroy & Boch ↗

IBM Plex Sans

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

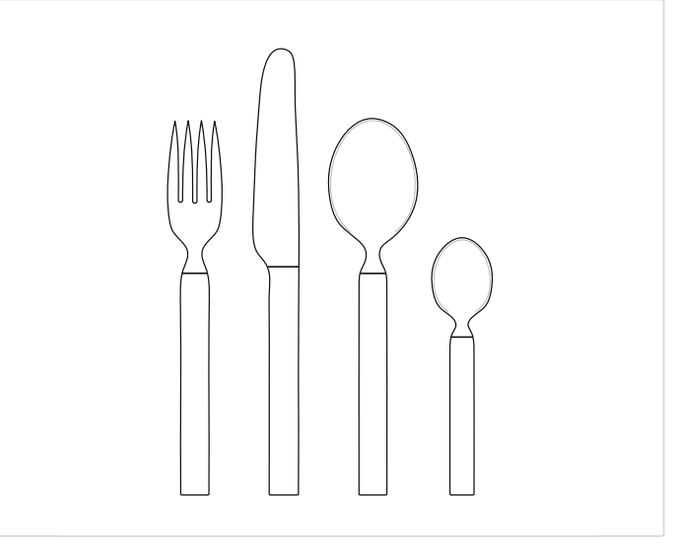
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“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Mike Abbink (IBM), with Bold Monday
MODEL	IBM's own neutral but friendly grotesque, built around the relationship between people and machines
CLASS	Sans · grotesque · on Google Fonts since 2018

Dry



DESIGNER	Achille Castiglioni
MATERIAL	18/10 stainless steel, mirror polished with matt handles
FORM	Handles like a bar ingot with straight sides; satin handles against polished heads; off-centre oval bowls

Character profile



Why they match

Both show the machine and then soften it. Dry keeps part of the steel bar it was cut from as its handle; Plex keeps engineered details inside a grotesque meant to feel friendly. Industrial honesty with a quiet sense of humour.

Sources: alessi.com · V&A collections · moma.org · Google Fonts

See it at Alessi ↗

Marcellus

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

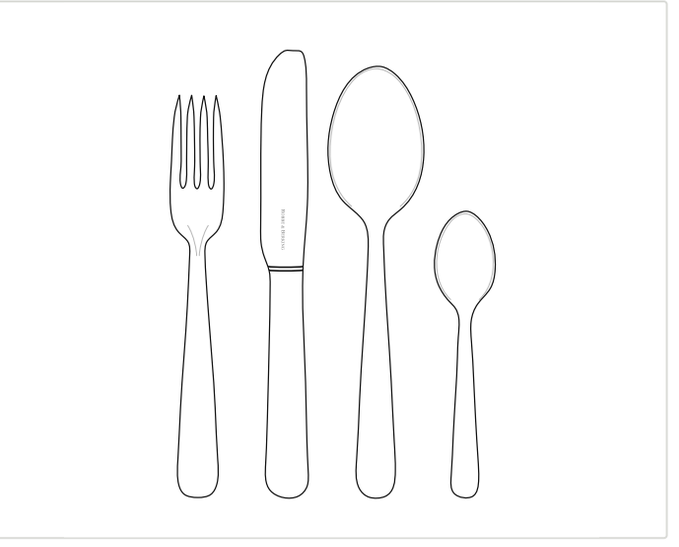
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“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

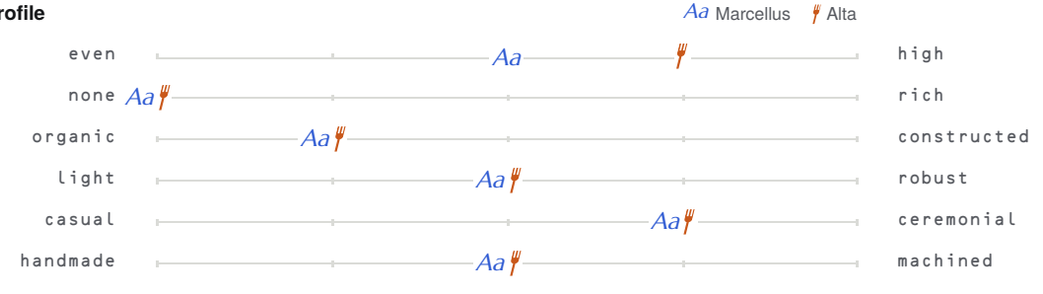
DESIGNER	Brian J. Bonislawsky (Astigmatic)
MODEL	Classic Roman inscription letterforms; the stems flare at their ends instead of carrying serifs
CLASS	Serif · flared · on Google Fonts since 2012

Alta



DESIGNER	Wilfried Moll, Hamburg silversmith
MATERIAL	925 sterling silver or 150 g silver-plate
FORM	No ornament, shape over decoration; long lines whose width and weight change along the piece

Character profile



Why they match

Neither adds ornament; both get their character from a stroke that swells and thins. Marcellus flares its stems the way chiselled Roman capitals do, instead of adding serifs; Alta lets its width and weight change along one continuous line of silver.

Sources: robbeberking.com · artedona.com · Google Fonts

See it at Robbe & Berking ↗

Nunito

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Vernon Adams; extended by Jacques Le Bailly (Cyreal)
MODEL	A well-balanced sans with rounded terminals, begun as display type and grown into a full superfamily
CLASS	Sans · rounded · on Google Fonts since 2012

Nuovo Milano



DESIGNER	Ettore Sottsass
MATERIAL	18/10 stainless steel, mirror polished
FORM	Soft and rounded, smooth as an ocean rock; no sharp edges; substantial weight

Character profile



Why they match

Every edge is rounded off. Sottsass gave a traditional cutlery shape the feel of a pebble; Nunito gives a balanced sans rounded terminals. Both are generous in weight and informal in tone, made to be picked up without a second thought.

Sources: alessi.com · collections.lacma.org · Google Fonts

See it at Alessi ↗

Inter

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Rasmus Andersson
MODEL	A neutral grotesque designed for computer screens, with a tall x-height for small sizes
CLASS	Sans · neo-grotesque · on Google Fonts since 2020

KnifeForkSpoon



DESIGNER	Jasper Morrison
MATERIAL	18/10 stainless steel
FORM	Archetypal, ordinary profiles; no decorative styling; one-piece knife

Character profile



Why they match

Both aim to disappear into use. Morrison spent years on quarter-millimetre corrections so the set would look like the cutlery everyone already knows; Inter refines the neutral grotesque for the screen. This is the closest either field gets to Frutiger's forgettable spoon.

Sources: jaspermorrison.com · alessi.com · Google Fonts

See it at Alessi ↗

Aa FONT

Great Vibes

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Robert Leuschke
MODEL	A flowing script: casual capitals over formal lowercase, with over 2,000 glyphs, connecting ligatures and alternates
CLASS	Script · connected · on Google Fonts since 2012

Jardin d'Eden



DESIGNER	Marcel Wanders (studio)
MATERIAL	Silver-plated, with some sterling silver pieces
FORM	All-over stamped engraving of interlaced leaves, flowers and curls; one continuous line runs over handle and back

Character profile





Why they match

Both are drawn with a line that never lifts. Wanders runs one engraved line across handle and back; Great Vibes joins letter to letter through smooth ligatures and alternates. Ornament is the whole point here, and both work hard to make it look effortless.

Sources: christofle.com · openers.jp · Google Fonts

See it at Christofle ↗

Chakra Petch

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

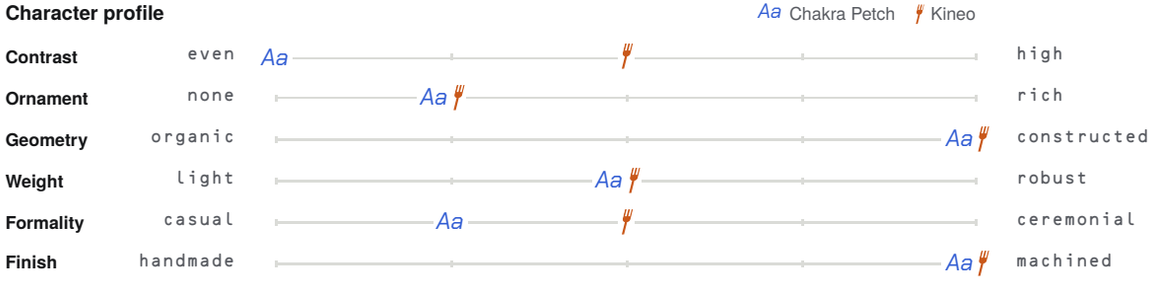
DESIGNER	Cadson Demak
MODEL	A square Thai and Latin sans with tapered corners, keeping Thai's traditional looped letterforms
CLASS	Sans · square · on Google Fonts since 2018

Kineo



DESIGNER	WMF in-house design team
MATERIAL	Cromargan protect 18/10 stainless steel, polished facets
FORM	Polished facets that change with the viewing angle; straight lines with optical breaks; stepped gaps between the tines

Character profile



Why they match

Both replace curves with cuts. Kineo's facets catch the light in straight-edged planes that shift as you turn the piece; Chakra Petch trims each squared letter with tapered corners. Precise, technical and a little restless.

Sources: wmf.com · red-dot.org · Google Fonts

See it at WMF ↗

Quicksand

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

“If you remember the shape of a spoon with which you just ate some soup, then the spoon had a poor shape.”

– Adrian Frutiger

DESIGNER	Andrew Paglinawan; revised with Thomas Jockin in 2016
MODEL	A display sans built on geometric shapes with rounded terminals, begun in 2008
CLASS	Sans · rounded geometric · on Google Fonts since 2011

Minimale



DESIGNER	Matteo Thun and Antonio Rodriguez
MATERIAL	18/10 stainless steel; polished, matt, hammered Vintage or PVD-coated
FORM	Monobloc; rounded Soft-Line handle ends; gently curved lines; discreet matte finish

Character profile



Why they match

Minimal does not have to mean hard. Minimale rounds the ends of a one-piece form and leaves it matte; Quicksand builds letters from geometric shapes and rounds every terminal. Both are light, calm and pleasant to touch, or to read.

Sources: zwilling.com · culinaris.de · Google Fonts

See it at Zwilling ↗